

# Never Lose a Quote to a Slow Reply Again

The Follow-Up System That Closes More Jobs  
— Using AI You Already Have

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[buildcrystal.ai](https://buildcrystal.ai)

# How many quotes did you send last month?

Now — how many did you actually follow up on?

If you're like most contractors I work with, the answer is: not enough. You meant to. You just got pulled to the next job, the next call, the next fire. And somewhere in there, a \$4,000 install went to the guy who got back to the customer first.

The average contractor follows up on less than half their quotes. Not because they don't care — because they're running a business with their hands full. Literally.

This guide fixes that. In about ten minutes, you'll have a system that turns AI into your follow-up machine. Not some generic chatbot — an AI that knows your business, writes like you, and drafts follow-ups in 30 seconds flat.

## TRY IT RIGHT NOW

You probably have a quote sitting unfollowed-up right now. Open ChatGPT, Claude, or whatever AI chat you have. Paste this, fill in the brackets, and hit send:

*I run a [TRADE] company called [BUSINESS NAME] in [CITY]. We're [CASUAL / PROFESSIONAL / FRIENDLY] with customers — I talk to them like a normal person, not a corporation.*

*Draft a follow-up email to [CUSTOMER NAME]. I gave them a quote for [SERVICE] at \$[AMOUNT] on [DATE]. Keep it short and friendly — I'm just checking in, not pressuring them. Ask if they have any questions and let them know the quote is good for 30 days. Sign off as [YOUR NAME].*

Read the output. Tweak anything that doesn't sound like you. **Send it.** That's a quote saved in 30 seconds.

### BEFORE AI

The email lives in your head for a week. The customer calls the other guy. You never know you lost the job.

### AFTER AI

30 seconds. Done. Sent. Next quote.

Now let's make it work even better.

## Step 1: Give It Context (5 minutes)

That first follow-up worked okay — but the AI barely knew anything about you. Here's the trick: **the more the AI knows about your business, the better everything it writes sounds.**

Think of it like onboarding a new office person. You wouldn't hand them a phone and say "figure it out." You'd spend five minutes telling them about the company. That's what this is.

**Fill this out once, save it on your phone, and paste it at the start of any AI conversation:**

### Your Business Brief

#### My Business

I run [BUSINESS NAME], a [TRADE] company in [CITY/REGION]. We have [NUMBER] employees and mostly serve [homeowners / commercial / property managers / etc.].

#### What We Do

Our most common jobs are [TOP 3 SERVICES]. A typical job runs \$ [AMOUNT]. Most leads come from [referrals / Google / yard signs / etc.].

#### How I Talk to Customers

[Describe your style — "friendly and casual, first names, I text more than email" or "professional but warm" — whatever fits]

*Bonus: paste a real text or email you've sent a customer. Even a short one helps the AI nail your voice. But describing your style works fine too.*

#### What Matters Right Now

The biggest thing I'm trying to fix is [THING]. My biggest headache is [THING].

**Now try the follow-up again** — paste your Business Brief first, then the follow-up instructions from the previous page. Compare the two outputs. The second one sounds like you actually wrote it.

**That's the whole game.** More context = better output. Every time. Save your Brief where you can grab it fast — notes app, text file, whatever works.

## Step 2: Build Your Follow-Up System (10 minutes)

One follow-up is good. A whole set of them is a system. A **prompt** is just written instructions you give the AI — the same way you'd tell an employee what to do. No coding. Save the ones that work so you're not starting from scratch every time.

### The Day-3 Check-In

For quotes 2-5 days old — friendly, low pressure

*Using the context I gave you about my business, draft a friendly check-in email to [CUSTOMER NAME]. I quoted them [SERVICE] at \$[AMOUNT] on [DATE]. I'm not pushing — just seeing if they have questions. Keep it short, one paragraph max. Sound like me.*

### The Week-2 Nudge

For quotes going cold — helpful, not desperate

*Using the context I gave you about my business, draft a follow-up to [CUSTOMER NAME]. I quoted them [SERVICE] at \$[AMOUNT] two weeks ago and haven't heard back. Mention that I wanted to make sure the quote didn't get buried in their inbox. Offer to answer any questions or adjust the scope if needed. Friendly, not desperate.*

### The Last-Chance Check

30 days — quote about to expire

*Using the context I gave you about my business, draft a final follow-up to [CUSTOMER NAME]. Their quote for [SERVICE] at \$[AMOUNT] expires in a few days. Let them know I'd hate for them to miss the pricing if they're still interested, and that I'm happy to re-quote if their needs changed. Keep it warm — this is a relationship, not a transaction.*

### The "We Just Finished" Review Ask

Day of completion — ask while they're happy

*Using the context I gave you about my business, draft a quick follow-up to [CUSTOMER NAME]. We just finished [SERVICE] at their place today. Thank them, let them know to reach out if anything comes up, and ask if they'd be willing to leave us a Google review. Keep it personal — mention the specific work we did.*

### After the Job: Referral Tap

After a good job — plant the seed

*Using the context I gave you about my business, draft a message to [CUSTOMER NAME]. We finished their [SERVICE] job [TIMEFRAME] ago and they seemed happy with the work. Ask if they know anyone else who might need [RELATED SERVICE]. Keep it casual — I'm not asking them to be a salesperson, just planting the seed.*

That's five prompts. Use just these and you'd follow up on every quote and every completed job — automatically remembering the stuff you'd normally forget.

### Companion Prompt Sheet included

These 5 prompts plus 8 more for estimates, complaints, crew instructions, and more.

Print it. Tape it to your desk. Grab it from [buildcrystal.ai/prompts](https://buildcrystal.ai/prompts)

## Step 3: Make It Stick (And Know the Limits)

When the AI writes something that doesn't sound right — don't start over. Correct it. Just like you would with a new employee.

*"That's too formal. I'd never say 'I hope this finds you well.' Rewrite it like a normal person."*

*"Don't use my last name in the sign-off, just 'Austin.'"*

*"We don't do 'net 30' — our quotes are good for 30 days from the date."*

It adjusts immediately. Within the same conversation, every correction sticks.

### ⚠ HERE'S WHAT I'LL BE STRAIGHT WITH YOU ABOUT

When you close the chat and open a new one, the AI forgets everything. Your corrections, your preferences, your style — gone. Starting from scratch.

That's the biggest limitation of AI chat tools right now. **It's a real one.**

But that's exactly why you saved your Business Brief and your prompts. They carry the knowledge the AI can't hold onto yet. Every time you correct something important, **add it to your Brief:**

*"Never say 'I hope this finds you well.' Always sign off as just my first name. We text more than email — keep everything short."*

Over time, your Brief gets better. Your prompts get sharper. The AI gets better because **you** got better at telling it what you need.

Use AI



Correct Mistakes



Update Brief / Prompts



Better Output



Repeat

### Now imagine an AI that remembers every correction on its own.

One that learns overnight, updates its own notes, and shows up tomorrow better than it was today. Where you never paste a brief because it already knows your business, your voice, your customers, and your preferences — permanently.

That's what I'm building at **Crystal**. It's the full version of this system — an AI that works like an actual employee who gets better every single day.

## The Math

Here's why follow-ups matter more than they seem.

Say you're an HVAC contractor. You send 30 quotes a month. Average job is \$3,500. You close about 40% — that's 12 jobs, \$42,000 a month.

Now say following up consistently bumps your close rate from 40% to 55%. That's not aggressive — that's just what happens when customers hear from you twice instead of zero times after the quote.

# +\$14,000

per month

From sending follow-up emails you were already going to write.  
The AI doesn't find you new customers. It makes sure the ones you already talked to don't fall through the cracks.

## 40%

Close rate without  
consistent follow-up

**\$42,000/mo**



## 55%

Close rate with  
consistent follow-up

**\$56,000/mo**

## What's Next

This system works. If all you ever do is paste a Business Brief and run follow-up prompts, you're ahead of 90% of contractors in your market.

But this is the manual version — you're still the one pasting, prompting, and remembering to follow up.

The full version runs on its own. AI that knows your business permanently, follows up without being told, and handles every customer touchpoint — not just quotes — while you're on a job site. **That's Crystal.**

I'm building it in public and writing about all of it — what works, what breaks, and what I'd do differently.

**Want to see what Crystal looks like for a business like yours?**

Reply to this email and tell me your biggest headache. I read every one.

— Austin

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